



Gap Control

Angela Ruggiero - Lesson 4 companion - ~25 min on ice

Warm-up - 5 min

- Two laps easy, crossovers both directions
- Honest feet: 10 backward starts, chin up, stick on ice
- Partner mirror drill, blue line to red line, 4 reps

Drill 1 - Two-touch angling walls - 8 min

- Attacker carries wide at half speed; defender steers with stick on puck side
- Two touches maximum before the wall - time the gap off their SECOND stride
- Progress to game speed on rep 5; switch roles every 2 reps

Drill 2 - Gap ladder - 8 min

- Cones at 4, 6, and 8 feet - coach calls the gap, defender adjusts inside 3 strides
- Fail condition: crossing your feet - reset the rep
- Finish each rep boxing out to the dot

Write it down

- Which stride told you the truth today - first or second?
- One gap you kept honest and one you lost - what changed?